

Newsletter, June 2026



SORTEE

Society for Open, Reliable, and Transparent
Ecology and Evolutionary Biology

Website: <https://www.sortee.org/>

Instagram: www.instagram.com/sortecoevo/

Twitter/X: [@sortecoevo](https://twitter.com/sortecoevo)

Bluesky: <https://bsky.app/profile/sortee.bsky.social>

LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/company/sortee/

Slack: <https://sortee.slack.com/>

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Message from the Board of Directors

Dear SORTEE Community,

We would like to share two governance-related updates from the Board of Directors.

Secretary Transition

In May 2026, our colleague Matthieu Paquet stepped down from his role as Secretary. We would like to thank Matthieu for his dedicated service in this position and for his many contributions to SORTEE over the years.

Matthieu has been involved with SORTEE since the Society's early days. His contributions date back to the founding years of SORTEE, when he began volunteering with the Conference Committee. Since then, he has served as Chair of the Conference Committee in 2023, Chair of the Fundraising Committee in 2024, and as a member of several other committees. He has also served on the Board of Directors since 2024. We are grateful for the time, energy, and leadership he has contributed across many areas of the Society.

Following Matthieu's resignation from the Secretary position, the Board initiated a process to identify a replacement Secretary to serve for the remainder of the term. After reviewing expressions of interest among Board members, Juliette Tariel-Adam was appointed to serve as Secretary until 31 December 2026.

Juliette has also contributed to SORTEE through a range of committees and initiatives over the past several years. Most notably, she served as Chair of the 2025 Conference Committee, where she brought new ideas and perspectives to the conference planning process, including helping establish the conference microgrants program. In 2026, she joined the Board of Directors and has continued to contribute her energy, expertise, and leadership to the Society. We are grateful to Juliette for stepping into this important leadership role and look forward to working with her in the months ahead.

2025 Board Election Process

The Board would also like to provide additional context to the 2025 Board election process. In 2025, three Board positions were open and three eligible candidates were nominated. The Board proceeded on the understanding that, because the number of candidates matched the number of available positions, the candidates would be elected unopposed and that a ballot was therefore not required. This understanding was informed based on the SORTEE's voting system which is designed to rank candidates for available seats and, in this instance, there were no contested positions to be decided by a vote. As a result, no ballot was distributed, the candidates were announced as elected by acclamation to the available Board positions at the SORTEE Annual General Meeting in November 2025.

In April 2026, we received a written inquiry about the 2025 electoral process. The Board takes these questions seriously and appreciates members who have taken the time to share their perspectives. The board acknowledges the lack of specification in SORTEE's bylaws in situations where the number of candidates is equal to or fewer than the number of available positions and, as such, the SORTEE members' right to vote. To support transparency and ensure a shared understanding of our governance processes, the Board is reviewing the relevant bylaws and internal procedures to improve future election processes and filling SORTEE leadership positions. We invite any SORTEE members with governance questions to email us at contact@sortee.org at any stage.

As a community-led organization, SORTEE benefits from the thoughtful engagement of its members. We are committed to transparency, clear communication, and continuous improvement of our governance processes, and we will keep members informed and included in the future developments.

Thank you for your ongoing support of SORTEE.

Registration for the SORTEE Conference 2026 is now open!

The **sixth annual SORTEE Conference** will run continuously from **13th October 07:00 UTC to 14th October 10:00 UTC** to cover all time zones. Conference **registration is now open**, please register via:

<https://events.humanitix.com/sortee-conference-2026>.

Registration is **free** for SORTEE members.

To receive updates about the conference, please click [here](#) to join the dedicated conference mailing list. We send approximately 8 emails per year with important updates.

Please help us spread the word by inviting your colleagues!

Conference content submission is now closed and we are working on delivering a fantastic program filled with exciting interactive events (unconferences, hackathons, workshops, plenaries and introductions to open science). The program will be published soon on the [SORTEE webpage](#), so keep an eye out for updates.

Do you have any questions regarding the conference, please write to us at conference@sortee.org. If in doubt about the conference accessibility, please check <https://sortee.org/upcoming/#accessibility> or feel free to ask us any questions at conference@sortee.org. You can also complete this [anonymous accessibility form](#).

Also, this year we are introducing microgrants. Do you experience any barriers to attending the SORTEE Conference in October? Will a small financial contribution help you overcome this? Stay tuned on the SORTEE Slack, the conference mailing list or at sortee.org/upcoming to apply.

See you in October!

[The SORTEE Conference Committee](#)

June SORTEE Code Club session

Date: Tuesday, 30.06.2026 (30 June, 2026)

Time: 9:00-10:00 UTC +01:00

Join us for a session about coding standards based on the SORTEE code guidelines for data and code quality control. We will discuss standardised guidelines regarding data and code quality control and archiving based on input from SORTEE members and multiple data editors. Eager to learn how to neatly organise and distribute your code and data for your next manuscript? Then this session is for you!

Code club zoom link:

<https://us06web.zoom.us/j/88966910825?pwd=EoeGnHaOr68eqeba7DaMBnSRcXtoa.p.1>

Going to the ISBE conference in Turino?

SORTEE will be sharing a stall with PCI/PCJ at the [ISBE conference](#) (International Society for Behavioural Ecology) in Turin on July 20–24 – come find us at our little open science corner!

We'll also be giving a presentation during Monday's lunch break, from 14:00 to 14:40.

We'd be very grateful for volunteers to help run the stall (some familiarity with how SORTEE works would be helpful).

If you're able to lend a hand, please get in touch at juliette.tarieladam@gmail.com.

Looking forward to seeing you there!

In person meet-ups: sign up and support

Conference season is starting! Going to an eco-evo conference in the coming months? Then take this opportunity to promote SORTEE and/or meet SORTEE members in person. Conference season is starting! Going to an eco-evo conference in the coming months? Then take this opportunity to promote SORTEE and/or meet SORTEE members in person.

Promote SORTEE by handing out stickers and flyers or apply with a SORTEE poster presentation. Or organize a meetup: meetups can be as casual and informal as you wish, with members only, or if you're up for it, you can organize a bigger meetup, inviting potential new SORTEE members to the mix. In any case, we ask you to sign up for your in person event (link below). The Member Engagement committee will then be in touch to provide you with a roadmap for how to organize your event and will add it to the list of upcoming events.

[Sign up form for SORTEE in person meetups and support](#)

You can find all planned SORTEE in-person meet-ups at upcoming eco-evo conferences [here](#).

Find more information about in person meetups [on the SORTEE website](#).

Want to contact the DEI committee?

You can reach the SORTEE DEI committee at the following email address: dei@sortee.org

Fundraising Committee updates

We are grateful that many of our previous sponsors have renewed their support for SORTEE in 2026: [Dryad](#), Peer Community In ([PCI](#)), the [Royal Society](#), [Canadian Science Publishing](#), and the Society for the Study of Evolution ([SSE](#)). In addition, we have a new sponsor, [Physalia-courses](#)! Physalia-courses provide hands-on scientific training courses and workshops covering a variety of topics in bioinformatics, ecological modeling, statistics, and data science, including reproducible data analysis in R.

We also received a grant from the [Company of Biologists](#) through their Fund for Innovations in Sustainable Conferencing initiative, which will help fund the 2026 annual conference.

The generous support of these organizations helps sustain SORTEE's core activities and services, including our annual conference, Workshop & Webinar Series, official preprint server ([EcoEvoRxiv](#)), and meet-ups at in-person conferences. If any SORTEE members are interested in organizing an in-person meetup or workshop and would like assistance finding or applying for funding to support such an event, the Fundraising Committee is more than happy to help. Finally, please reach out to the chair of the Fundraising Committee, Ruby Krasnow (ruby.krasnow@maine.edu), if you or any organization you know would be open to supporting SORTEE!



Nominate your/a project for the 2026 SORTEE Commendation Award!

Dear SORTEE members,

Do you know a project that promotes open, reliable, and transparent research practices in ecology and evolutionary biology (EcoEvo)? Consider nominating it for the 2026 SORTEE Commendation Award!

The Commendation Award recognizes initiatives that advance Open Science in EcoEvo. Projects may include (but are not limited to) journal clubs, workshops, seminar series, tools, websites, repositories, educational resources, podcasts, public talks, or other initiatives that foster a more transparent and reliable research culture. Both individual and team-based projects are welcome, and projects can be local or global in scope.

Nominations are open until 31 August 2026. Eligible projects will be reviewed by the SORTEE Awards Committee and approved by the Board of Directors. Awardees will be announced during the SORTEE Virtual Conference in October 2026.

If you have a project in mind, or know someone doing inspiring work, please consider submitting a nomination.

Learn more about eligibility and submit a nomination: <https://sortee.org/awards/>.

Add links to sortee.org on your website

If you have a website, please consider adding a link to sortee.org. The more websites that link to sortee.org, the higher our search engine rankings will be. This will help people searching on Google or other search engines find us more readily. Thanks!

Submit to the SORTEE Newsletter

We welcome submissions to our newsletter. If you know of anything that SORTEE should or could announce (events, publications, announcements, ideas) in our newsletter, please let us know by sending an email to the newsletter editor, Tim Parker parkerth@whitman.edu with "SORTEE Newsletter" in the header (We do not advertise commercial services or products)

2026 SORTEE leadership team

Marija Purgar (Board Member, President, Awards Committee Chair)

Malgorzata (Losia) Lagisz (Board Member, President-elect)

Juliette Tariel-Adam (Board Member, Secretary)

Ed Ivimey-Cook (Past-President, Advocacy Committee Co-Chair)

Christian John (Treasurer)

Michael Bertram (Board Member)

Stephanie Flaman (Board Member, Conference Committee Chair)

Ineta Kacergytė (Board Member)

Matthieu Paquet (Board Member)

Aidan Tan (Board Member)

Joel Pick (Advocacy Committee Co-Chair)

Brooke Long-Fox (DEI Committee Co-Chair)

Mark Young (DEI Committee Co-Chair)

Stefan Vriend (EcoEvoRxiv Committee Chair)

Saoirse Kelleher (Education and Outreach Committee Chair)

Ruby Krasnow (Fundraising Committee Chair)

Oakleigh Wilson (Media Committee Co-Chair)

Swastika Issar (Media Committee Co-Chair)

Natalie van Dis (Member Engagement Committee Chair)